

How The Independent Executive Compares

We reviewed about 45 programs across career/outplacement, fractional-consulting, and AI-for-leaders. None teaches all five skills, and none prepares an executive for both a promotion and an independent practice.

	The Independent Executive	TalentGuy	RiseSmart Premier	Right Management	Find My Profession	Pavilion	Chief	Consulting Success	Fractional Exec Connection	Pathway to Fractional	Dorie Clark	#befractional	Fractional Officer	Going Fractional	Consulting Bridge	Mastery Insights Dr. Grace Lee	BetterUp / CoachHub	MIT xPRO / Wharton
Price	\$6,800 founding \$10,000 list	\$10,500 120 days	\$6,499 / 12 mo employer-paid	Not public employer-paid	\$3,000/mo or \$1.5K+8%	\$2,700 / yr	~\$5,800 / yr 2023	Five figures	\$47/mo – \$12K+	\$3K / \$5K	\$2,495	\$875 + \$875 AI	\$379	£300	\$67 – \$1,297	\$6,000 / yr + \$349/mo	B2B only	\$850 – \$13,500
Value proposition	✓	✓	Partial	Partial	Partial	Partial	—	✓	✓	✓	Partial	✓	✓	✓	✓	Partial	—	—
Executive presence	✓ weekly call	Partial pitch only	Partial	Partial	—	—	Partial	—	—	—	Partial	—	—	—	—	✓	✓	—
Consulting	✓	✓	Partial mention	Partial no curriculum	—	✓ GTM only	Partial	✓	✓	✓	Partial	✓	✓	✓	Partial	—	—	—
Brand & outreach	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	Partial	Partial	Partial	✓	✓	✓	Partial	Partial	✓	—	Partial	—	—
Agentic AI	✓ AI Lab + Sherpa	✓	—	—	—	✓	Partial	✓	Partial	—	Partial	✓	✓ lead agents	Partial	✓	—	Partial	✓
Career	✓	— excludes job seekers	✓	✓	✓	✓ CMO/CRO	Partial	—	—	—	Partial	—	—	—	✓ while you search	✓	Partial	—
Guarantee	Promoted, new job, or \$10K — or we keep working	Until first client	None	None	5 interviews or an offer in 4 mo	None	None; women only	None	None	Refund thru wk 4	No refunds	None	30-day refund	14-day refund	None	None	None	None

Key: ✓ yes Partial partial — no. The five skills: value proposition, executive presence, consulting, brand & outreach, and agentic AI.

Also reviewed, mostly single-lane: Korn Ferry Advance, LHH, BlueSteps, Ivy Exec, ExecThread, Cultivated Culture, The Muse, Executive Career Brand, Voyageur U, Connectd, Fractional Institute, Fractional Executive Institute, Alan Weiss, Harvard DCE consulting, Justin Welsh LinkedIn OS, Escape the City, Endeavor Executive, Chief Outsiders, GoFractional, Catalant, Fractionals United, Vistage, YPO, EO, HBS PLD, Section AI, ExecOnline, and Maven agentic-AI cohorts. None teaches all five skills plus the leverage model.

Based on each program's public pages as of September 21, 2026. Prices from vendor pages unless noted.